

ECON 301—ECONOMETRICS I

UPDATES DUE TO COVID19 EMERGENCY

Spring 2020

Department of Economics
Nazarbayev University

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Lecture time/Location: Asynchronous delivery, i.e. we will not hold traditional lectures virtually, but instead I will facilitate you the material so you can study at your own pace. Most of the activities and communication will be through Moodle and email. I will also hold virtual office hours (see below) using Skype, Zoom and Jitsi.

Office hours: We will have two formats of office hours.

Individual meetings	Individual meetings are by appointment, book at https://alejandromelo.youcanbook.me , please sign at least one day in advance, and these meetings will be through Skype (live:.cid.a016cfb4ad43d1b5). The maximum time allotted to each student will be 10-15 minutes.
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Group meetings	From time to time, we will conduct group office hours using the applications Zoom or Jitsi. Both of these software applications are used to conduct video conferences. Depending on the preferences, availability and needs of the class, I will post the times, in Moodle, at which we will hold these group office hours after consulting with the group. You will be able to join the video conference and ask me questions about the material. These sessions are not obligatory to attend, since for some of you it may be impossible, because of lack of sufficient bandwidth, to stream the session.
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Updates about the course format, delivery and topics covered This document reflects the updated syllabus for the last part of the course. ***Please read it carefully!***

We will migrate to an **asynchronous online delivery** for the rest of the course. This means that we will no longer hold traditional lectures virtually at the usual time of the class. Instead, I will prepare material for you (slides, notes, audio commentary, short videos, etc.), which together with the book, you will have to study at your own pace. The reason for this change in format is that, unfortunately, many students simply do not have the stable Internet connection or the appropriate resources required to participate in regular live virtual lectures. However, as detailed above, we will still be able to have face-to-face interaction through the office hour sessions.

A second important point is that I will have to shorten the amount of topics covered due to the shortened semester. In terms of content I will cover the following remaining topics:

1. Multiple Regression: the linear regression model in matrix form, proofs of unbiasedness and efficiency using the new notation, the Gauss-Markov Theorem. This corresponds to an extension of Chapter 3 using the matrix notation that I introduced before the break.
2. Multiple Regression: Inference. In this part, I will reap the benefits of introducing the matrix notation to develop in a parsimonious way the topics from Chapter 4 in the book. We will study the sampling distribution of the OLS estimator and use it to derive a hypothesis tests about the parameters and linear functions of the parameters.

3. Multiple Regression: Asymptotics. In this part, we will study the asymptotic properties, i.e., large sample properties, of the OLS estimators. We will discuss the notion of consistency and convergence in distribution and study the behavior of the OLS estimators using these notions.

The previous three topics will be evaluated in the Final exam (see below) and are also the base knowledge that you will need to complete your research project (see below).

Furthermore, I will post extra material concerning chapters 6–9 from the book; this material will be optional and you will only need to consult it if you need it for your research project.

Course Material All course materials and lecture notes will be posted in Moodle. Remember that you can access the textbook, *Introductory Econometrics by Jeffrey Wooldridge* through Moodle.

Course Grade The method of evaluation remains qualitatively the same: there will be quizzes, homework assignments, a midterm exam, a final exam, and a research project. However, there will be some *quantitative changes* regarding the proportion of the final grade assigned to each item.

Quizzes will remain the same as in the previous version of the syllabus, however, they will now be given through Moodle. The grading criteria remains the same, i.e., a minimum grade of 5 if you take the quiz. However, you should expect now to have at the minimum, a weekly quiz, and a maximum of two quizzes per week. This is to give you incentives to keep your study schedule.

Homework assignments will remain mostly the same, except that you will have to deliver them through Moodle. Also, we will have 3 or 4 more assignments before the end of the course.

The final exam will be on **April 29** as scheduled by the Registrar. There are two possible options:

Option 1. An online exam during the time scheduled by the Registrar, 9 AM to 11 AM. The exam would be deployed through Moodle.

Option 2. If the above option is not possible due to technical constraints, I can give you a take-home exam with a 24 hour deadline.

Since the neither of the above two options are ideal in terms of what I wanted to measure from the original setup of the final exam, the weight of this component will be decrease.

The final numeric grade will be calculated using the following **updated weights**:

Components	Weight
Pop-up Quizzes	10%
Homework Assignments	10%
Midterm	30%
Final Exam	15%
Research Project (more on this in the next section)	35%

The numeric grade will be curved to obtain the letter grade. As you can see, now the research project, which you can do at your own pace will have the highest weight in the grade.

Research Project Finding a topic is an important part of the exercise: I won't offer suggestions (although I will be happy to respond to preliminary ideas that you come up with). The paper should be short: 5–10 pages (excluding title and reference pages) discussing the econometric analysis of a group of economic or socioeconomic variables of your choice. It should be well written. You are encouraged to use the Writing Center for help with this.

As you can see, this component remains mostly the same compared to the original syllabus. However, there are a few changes:

You are encouraged to work together for your research project **with a limit of maximum 6 people** per project. The project is due by **Friday, May 7 at 5 PM**. Thus, I have increased the maximum team size and the deadline for the project.

The research project grade is determined using the following rubric:

Components	Weight
Introduction and motives for the research	15%
Integration of the literature review into the paper	15%
Model and pretests	20%
Results and inference	20%
Conclusions	15%
Grammar, writing quality	15%

Rules and Regulations & Academic Misconduct Everything here remains the same as in the original syllabus. In particular, I will keep having a ***zero tolerance policy towards cheating and academic misconduct.***